GNA Global Services
IT SECURITY & STRATEGY FOR SMALL BUSINESS

Before You Pay a Changed Bank Account: 6 Checks That Stop Fake Vendor Payments

A vendor emails to say they've "switched banks." Sometimes it's true. Often it's a scammer who has copied or hacked the vendor's email. Once the money is sent, it's very hard to get back. Do these checks every time, before any money moves.

1. ☐ **Stop and hold the payment.** Don't pay the new account, and don't reply to the email yet. A real vendor won't mind waiting a day.
2. ☐ **Check the sender's address closely.** Compare it letter by letter with the one you have on file. billing@acme-supp1y.com is not billing@acme-supply.com.
3. ☐ **Watch for pressure.** Messages like "Pay today or the job stops" or "Don't call, just reply here" are warning signs.
4. ☐ **Call the vendor on a number you already have.** Use your records or their official website, never a number from the email. Ask them to confirm the new bank details out loud.
5. ☐ **Write it down.** Note who you spoke to, the date and the time. For large or unusual amounts, have a second person approve the change.
6. ☐ **Make it a rule for everyone.** No bank-detail change without a call-back, and that includes part-timers and anyone filling in. If a payment already looks wrong, call your bank right away, because speed matters.

If any check fails, don't pay.

Next step: is your own email safe?

Scammers also pretend to be you when they email your clients. The **GNA IT Security Review ($149)** checks your key email accounts and payment steps for the gaps these scams use, and gives you a short, prioritized fix list. Start at gnaitservices.com/security-review.

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